

ChatGPT-Based Storytelling

Student: Sameer Karur

Deliverable type: Interactive ChatGPT storytelling adventure with prompt engineering (no extra platforms).

1. Objective

Create a unique interactive narrative with ChatGPT: define theme and characters, start a scene, take player actions, generate AI responses, branch on decisions, refine prompts, and reach a satisfying conclusion.

2. Theme and title

Genre: science-fiction mystery (space-station noir). Working title: Signal from Hab-Deck 7. Hook: junior systems engineer Kai Okonkwo receives a distress ping from Hab-Deck 7, a sector that does not exist on public schematics of station Aurora-9.

3. Characters

- * Kai Okonkwo - protagonist, junior systems engineer, curious and ethical.
- * Dr. Mira Solene - chief medical officer, possible ally who knows the cover-up.
- * Director Hale Voss - station director who prioritizes company liability.
- * ECHO - station AI, helpful but redacted; glitches when Hab-Deck 7 is mentioned.

4. Prompt engineering approach

A master system prompt locks ChatGPT as Game Master: second-person voice, 150-220 word cap, exactly three A/B/C choices each turn, consequence tracking, allowed cast, and a required climax plus epilogue. An opening BEGIN STORY prompt sets location, character, and the distress alert.

5. Playthrough (chosen branch)

- * Turn 1: Opening in Engineering Bay 3. Player chooses B - maintenance tunnels.
- * Turn 2: Player chooses A - override hatch, leave a breadcrumb for Mira.
- * Turn 3: Inside Hab-7, ECHO-MIRROR files found. Player stalls Voss and copies files.
- * Turn 4: Meet Mira with the cold drive.
- * Turn 5 finale: Broadcast the truth station-wide. Open-hopeful epilogue / Inquiry Arc.

6. Iteration and refinement

- * Long rambling scenes -> hard 150-220 word limit.
- * Missing choices -> require exactly three numbered options every turn.
- * Tone drift -> lock tense, cinematic, no gore.
- * NPC inconsistency -> name allowed characters in the system prompt.
- * State tracker every few turns: location, inventory, trust, alert level.

7. Conclusion

The adventure is complete and shareable. Prompts, branch map, and a full session are documented in the notebook and screenshots. Source notebook: ChatGPT_Based_Storytelling.ipynb.